

Initial and Full Loop Interview Guide



Welcome to your preparation guide for your interview at Meta! This guide will take you approximately 90 minutes to review. Use the table of contents below to quickly jump to the section you are looking for. Whether you’re taking your initial screen or your full loop interview, our Engineering leaders and recruiters put together this guide so you know what to expect and how to prepare. We recognize that interviewing can be stressful, so we hope this guide provides the information and resources you need. Remember, your recruiter is there to support you, so please reach out to them with any questions.

What you’ll find in this guide

Accommodations process.....2

Team introduction..... 2

Interview process overview.....2

Technical Screen.....4

Full Loop Guide..... 6

- Behavioral..... 6
- Partnership..... 7
- IDC Problem Solving..... 8
- IDC Domain Expertise (Linux Systems and Automation).....8
- IDC Domain Expertise (Hardware and Data Center Operations).....9

Final tips for your interview.....10

Post interview – What to expect..... 11

Appendix / Resources..... 11

Accommodations process

Meta is committed to providing reasonable support (called accommodations) in our recruiting processes for qualified candidates with disabilities, physical conditions, mental health conditions, neurodivergence, sincerely held religious beliefs, pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions, as required by law. If you need assistance or require an accommodation, reach out via the [Accommodations request form](#).

Team introduction

Site Operations manages Meta's rapidly growing fleet of servers in our data centers and ensures mission-critical infrastructure, services, and data are always protected and available to our global community.

We provide world-class support to the teams on-site as well as the local communities where our data centers are located.

Interview process overview

This guide will explain what to expect during your interviews with Meta. As part of your interview, you will have the opportunity to meet with peers, cross-functional partners, and other leaders at Meta. Your recruiter will be your guide throughout the process and aim to adequately prepare you to bring your best self to your interview.

Get to Know your Recruiting Team

- **Recruiting Coordinator:** Scheduling interviews and coordination
- **Sourcer:** Initial contact regarding the role and opportunity: recruiter screen, initial screening interview prep, and updates related to initial screening interview
- **Recruiter:** Final contact when you reach the full loop and final stages: interview prep, full-loop updates and offer discussions

Breaking down the full interview process

- 30-45 min initial screening call with your Sourcer
- Technical Screen: One 45min Interview with an Engineer
- Receive Feedback from your Sourcer, 24 to 48 hours after your interview.
- If you are recommended to move forward in the process, you will receive an Introduction to a recruiter at Meta. They will schedule a 30-minute prep call with you and gather your availability for the next round of interviews.

- Full loop: Five 45min Interviews with different members of the team
- Recruiter will get in touch to discuss outcome

Video Conference interview best practices

- Make sure you're in a quiet environment.
- Double check that you have a reliable internet/phone connection.
- It's okay to ask the person you're speaking with to speak slowly if you can't catch what they're saying.
- You'll need a laptop with a webcam, speaker, and mic. We recommend using a headset or headphones with a mic for better quality audio, but this is optional.
- While we embrace the usage of advanced tooling in our day-to-day work to build the future of social connection, we ask that you not use any unauthorized outside assistance during interviews. Throughout the interview process you may be asked to share your screen via Zoom. Here you can find [guidance](#) on how this works. Additionally, we ask that you disable and not use filters during your interview. This will help us get an understanding of how you approach problem-solving and coding independently. Outside assistance includes, but is not limited to, consulting external resources, seeing help from others, or using AI tools, like ChatGPT.
 - For your interview, ensure Zoom screen sharing is enabled in advance, as setup may require a few minutes. Here's how: [Enable Zoom screen share](#).
 - A filter is considered any tool/feature that applies visual effects to your video feed, including virtual/blurred background.

Interview Dress Code

As you're probably aware, we promote a casual environment at Meta so that everyone can be their authentic selves. Formal dress is not required (jeans are definitely ok!). Dress comfortably. We care about what you can do, not what you wear.

Initial Technical Screen Guide

Welcome to the next step in your interview process with Meta! Your initial interview will consist of a single 45min screening interview with a member of the ProdOps Engineering Team. The call will be conducted over video conference; your career profile will provide all the details about who you'll meet.

What can you expect?

The interviewer has a prepared list of questions they need to get through, so please be as concise and efficient as possible with your answers. Be prepared to explain your work and technical work in detail. You will also be asked situational/scenario questions, so be prepared to provide specific examples. Quick tip, Answer questions using real-life examples, avoid using theoretical answers when possible. "What have you done VS What would you do".

Make sure you can provide a variety of examples within each category detailed below. Note that the order and time spent on each of the focus areas below can differ.

- Introduction (5min)
- Technical Depth (25min)
- Problem Solving (5min)
- Partnership (5min)
- Questions for your Interview (5min)

Technical Screen

What do we look for?

One important piece of advice for your interviews: it's ok if you don't know! No one who works at Meta is an expert in all things, and we don't look for perfection in the people we interview. If you aren't sure of something during your interview, you're encouraged to ask clarifying questions and be upfront if there are topics that you have less experience with. Your interviewer will be thinking about how your skills and experience might help Meta as well as how you tackle problems you're not as familiar with.

In your Technical Screen interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on four focus areas:

- **Linux Systems:** How do you navigate the command line? Where do you find key files? How does a kernel work and how can it break? How can you push commands out across multiple hosts? How do you assess the health of a system?
- **Hardware Troubleshooting:** What are the key components to a server and how do they affect each other? How can you troubleshoot and identify component failures from the command line? What are the most important diagnostic steps to take on a crashed server without terminal access?

- **Problem Solving:** What are some of the most impactful problems that you've solved? How did you identify them? What was the solve? Why was that the best solution? How did you measure success?
- **Partnership:** Who are your key partners, both in team and cross functional? What does strong partnership mean to you? How do you influence others? How do you deal with conflict?

Post Interview – What to Expect

You can expect your recruiter to provide a specific timeline or updates along the way. Your recruiter will inform you of next steps after your interview as soon as they are available. Feel free to follow up with them if you have not heard within a week of your interviews.

Full-Loop Interview Guide

Congrats! You've made it through your first interview! The next step now is to book your final interview, also known as a full loop. Your loop will consist of five 1:1 interviews that are 45 minutes each. You can expect the interviewers to include the hiring manager, potential teammates, and cross functional partners — all of whom you could be working with day to day in your role.

Make sure you can provide a variety of examples within each category, detailed below. Your career profile will provide all the details about who you'll meet, and this will be covered with your recruiter as well. Note that the order and composition of the 1:1s can differ.

- Introduction with Recruiting Coordinator: 15 minutes
- Behavioral: 45min
- IDC Problem Solving: 45min
- IDC Domain Expertise - Software and Automation: 45min
- IDC Domain Expertise - Hardware and Data Center Operations: 45min
- Partnership: 45min

Behavioral

What can you expect?

Meta's behavioral interview is designed for your interviewer to learn more about your background, what you're passionate about in the industry, and what kind of impact you want to make. The purpose of the behavioral interview is to assess if you would thrive in the company's fast-paced environment as well as your communication skills, openness, and critical thinking.

What do we look for?

Know yourself. Take the time to review your own resume as your interviewer will almost certainly ask questions about key events in your work history.

[Familiarize yourself with our six core values.](#) These values influence how we work together to fulfill our mission of bringing the world closer together.

How to prep

It may be helpful to think through how you would approach these sample questions:

- What projects are you most proud of?
- What were some excellent collaborations you've had?
- What kinds of technologies are you most excited about?
- Tell me about a time when you advocated for and pushed your own ideas forward despite opposition.
- Tell me about a time you received constructive feedback — what was it and how did you manage it?
- Tell me about a time you had conflict with a colleague. How did you resolve it? What did you learn?
- How do you like to give and receive feedback? Tell me about a time where you have had to give and receive tough feedback.

Partnership

What can you expect?

Meta's partnership interview evaluates your experience in building partnerships and working cross functionally on complex projects with many stakeholders. The purpose of the partnership interview is to assess how you manage conflict and build consensus where needed.

What do we look for?

Think of the specific people or different teams you interact with (for example, leadership, client groups, onsite construction teams) and how those relationships have functioned. Prepare examples of where you've been decisive and proactive in coordinating cross-functionally. Prepare examples of where you've had to deal with conflict and build consensus, negotiate, and find common ground.

How to prep

It may be helpful to think through how you would approach these sample questions:

- How would you develop new cross-functional relationships with various stakeholders?
- How do you lead a cross functional group discussion?
- How do you measure the health of a partnership?
- Tell me about a cross-functional project you led that you are most proud of.
- Tell me about a time you had a weak or failing partnership. How were you able to mend it?

IDC Problem Solving

What can you expect?

Meta's Infrastructure Data Center (IDC) problem-solving interview is intended to explore your domain expertise through your experience solving complex problems. This interview also evaluates the level of strategic thinking, creative problem solving, and your experience of working at scale.

What do we look for?

The key to this interview is having a framework for your response — the [STAR method](#) is recommended. Share your solution at a high level and then dive into a more detailed explanation of how. Think out loud and show your work! Also note any assumptions that are going into how you're solving a particular problem. Keep in mind that interviewers are looking for a solution that factors in scaling and future growth.

How to prep

It may be helpful to think through how you would approach these sample questions:

- Describe the most complex project you have managed. Think about details about the project size and stakeholders involved.
- If a project is experiencing delays, what levers might you pull to bring the project back on track?
- Tell me about a time you had to communicate large scale change? What drove this change?
- Tell me about a time you developed a creative way to remove risk from a project. How did you evaluate the criticality level of this risk?
- Tell me about a time when you realized there was an issue with an important element of a project after you were already underway. How did you handle it and what groups did you have to coordinate?

IDC Domain Expertise – Linux Systems and Automation

What can you expect?

This interview is focused on assessing your technical experience as it relates to software troubleshooting, Linux systems, and automation. The interviewer will be looking to understand your ability to work through technical challenges efficiently while driving clear communications out to other team members. How do you think through improving or creating repair or plan and build workflows? How would you measure and solve for issues that arise in our space?

What do we look for?

Review the job description for the role. Walk through the responsibilities and requirements and think through how your experience relates to each. In this Domain Expertise interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on three focus areas:

- Technical Depth
- Troubleshooting
- Working through technical issues within a team environment

How to prep

It may be helpful to think through how you would approach these sample questions:

- Walk me through your day-to-day use of Linux, what types of systems do you support?
- Tell me about your experience with automation tools. Where and how have you used them?
- Can you give me an example of a complex software issue you've had in the past? What other teams and vendors were involved? What went well and what could have gone better?
- Can you tell me how {_____} works? How can it break and how would you address the issue?
- How would you {_____} on a Linux server? How would you do it on 100 servers? How about 1000? 10,000?

IDC Domain Expertise – Hardware and Data Center Ops

What can you expect?

This interview is focused on assessing your technical experience as it relates to hardware and your ability to troubleshoot more complex problems related to servers, storage, and networking. The interviewer will be looking to understand your ability to work through technical challenges efficiently while driving clear communications out to other team members. How do you think through improving or creating repair or plan and build workflows? How would you measure and solve for issues that arise in our space?

What do we look for?

Review the job description for the role. Walk through the responsibilities and requirements and think through how your experience relates to each. In this Domain Expertise interview, your interviewer will assess your performance on three focus areas:

- Technical Depth

- Troubleshooting
- Working through technical issues within a team environment

How to prep

It may be helpful to think through how you would approach these sample questions:

- Tell me about your experience supporting HW platforms.
- Tell me about a complex hardware issue you've had to troubleshoot. What happened and what was your solution?
- What are the key differences between { } and { }? In what situations would you select one over the other?
- Can you tell me about a time when you were short on the parts needed to make the repairs? How did you prioritize which to work on first? How did you communicate this to the client?

Final Tips for your Interview

- **Be yourself.** This means being open and honest about your successes and ways you've improved throughout your career. Also, be sure to call out how you have specifically added value to your team or projects you've contributed to. We value teamwork and what each individual member brings to the table.
- **Carefully review and familiarize yourself with the job description and perform research on Meta and the role.** Be prepared to answer why you are interested in this specific role and in working at Meta.
- **Please take the time to review** our [mission statement](#) and [core values](#). These values influence how we work together to fulfill our mission of bringing the world closer together. We also encourage you to take time using our products such as Facebook, Instagram, Messenger, and WhatsApp.
- **Prepare thoughtful questions for the interviewer(s).** Your interviewer may challenge your ideas, and you should be ready to speak not only to what you recommend or have experienced but the why as well. It is important to think outside the box and to approach problems from creative and different perspectives.

Post Interview – What to Expect

You can expect your recruiter to provide a specific timeline or updates along the way. Your recruiter will inform you of next steps after your interview as soon as they are available. Feel free to follow up with them if you have not heard within a week of your interviews.

Appendix / Resources

Below is a curated list of resources to get started and help you prepare.

Role-specific prep

- [Meta data centers homepage](#)
- [Engineering at Meta](#)
- [Meta infrastructure](#)
- [Meta data center engineering](#)
- [Journey inside a Meta data center \(video\)](#)
- [Lifecycle of a Data Center \(video\)](#)
- [Open Compute Project \(OCP\)](#)
- [Twin Lakes 1S Server Design Specification](#)
- [Facebook 2S Server Tioga Pass](#)
- [OCP Summit 2022: Open hardware for AI infrastructure](#)
- [Building Meta's GenAI Infrastructure](#)
- [Introducing Our Next Generation Infrastructure for AI | Meta](#)
- [Infrastructure at Scale](#)
- Automation and Monitoring: [FBAR1](#) | [FBAR2](#)

Meta Resources

- [About Meta](#) website
- [Meta Newsroom](#) website
- [Meta Careers](#) website
- [Meta Life](#) website
- [Meta Employee Benefits](#) website
- [Interviewing at Meta: The keys to success](#) blog

Update personal information, track interview progress, and send thank you notes.

At any time during the interview process, you can track your progress, send thank-you notes and update your personal information all via the [Career Profile](#). If you do not receive a link from recruiting, you may create one.

Thank you for taking the time to review this guide!